WordPress Beginner Course — Class 3 Lesson Plan

Class 3: Installing WordPress & First Setup (on Hostinger)

■ Duration: 60 minutes · ■ Level: Absolute beginner · ■ Format: Online, screen-share demo + students follow along

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■ Learning Objectives

By the end of this class, every student should be able to:

1. Install WordPress on their own hosting using Hostinger's Auto Installer
2. Log in to their WordPress admin (`/wp-admin`)
3. Configure the 3 essential first settings (General, Permalinks, Reading)
4. Explain the difference between **Posts** and **Pages**
5. Create their first Page and first Post

■ Prerequisites (before class starts)

- Every student has an active Hostinger account (from Class 1)
- They know their Hostinger login
- Ask at the start of class: *"Everyone logged into hPanel? Type YES in chat"*

■ Class Timeline (60 min)

Block 1 — WordPress Installation on Hostinger (15 min)

Talking points / script:

> "Last class we saw the WordPress dashboard on my site. Today YOU get your own live website on the internet. We're going to install WordPress together — it takes about 2 minutes."

Live demo steps (share your screen):

1. Log in to **hPanel** → **Websites** tab
2. Click **Auto Installer** → choose **WordPress**
3. Fill in: - Website name (e.g., "My First Site") - Admin username → ■■ **NEVER use** `admin` (explain: hackers try this first) - Strong password → save it somewhere safe (password manager / notebook)
4. Leave everything else default → click **Install**
5. Wait ~2 minutes → show the success screen
6. Open the live site URL → **point out the padlock icon (SSL)** — tie back to Class 1

Say this:

> "See the padlock? That's the free SSL from Hostinger. It means your site is secure and visitors see it as trustworthy."

■ *If a student gets stuck here, tell them to type "STUCK" in chat — handle it in the Q&A buffer, don't derail the flow.*

Block 2 — First Login & Essential Settings (15 min)

Step 1: Log in (3 min)

- Go to `yourdomain.com/wp-admin`
- Log in with the username/password created earlier

- Quick tour reminder: *"This is the dashboard you saw in Class 2 — but now it's YOURS"*

Step 2: Settings → General (3 min)

- Set **Site Title** and **Tagline**
- Set **Timezone** (important for post scheduling later!)

Step 3: Settings → Permalinks (5 min) ■ *most important setting*

- Change from "Plain" to **"Post name"**
- **Say this:**

> "Compare these two URLs: `yoursite.com/?p=123` vs `yoursite.com/my-first-post`. The second one is readable for humans AND for Google. Always set this BEFORE you publish content, otherwise old links break later."

Step 4: Settings → Reading (2 min)

- Optional: tick *"Discourage search engines from indexing this site"* while we're still learning/building
- Tell them we'll untick it on the last day of the course

Step 5: Save all settings — show where the Save button is (beginners miss it!)

Block 3 — Posts vs Pages: The Big Concept (15 min)

> ■ This is the #1 beginner confusion point. Spend the full 15 minutes here.

Simple explanation (use this analogy):

> "Think of a book. **Pages** are like the cover, preface, and 'about the author' — they always stay in the same place. **Posts** are like diary entries — newest one appears first, and they pile up over time."

Side-by-side comparison (share this on screen):

	Pages	Posts
Purpose	Static content	Blog/news entries
Example	Home, About, Contact	Articles, tutorials, news
Date?	No	Yes (sorted newest first)
Categories/tags?	No	Yes
Shows in blog feed?	No	Yes

Live demos:

1. **Create a Page:** Pages → Add New → title "About Me" → type 2–3 lines → **Publish** → show it live on the front end
2. **Create a Post:** Posts → Add New → title "My First Post" → write a short paragraph → **Publish** → show it on the site
3. **Show the difference live:** visit both URLs — point out that the post has a date, the page doesn't

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Block 4 — Cleanup (10 min)

Say this:

> "WordPress comes with sample content, like a new house with some leftover boxes. Let's clear them out."

Do together:

1. Delete the **"Hello World"** post (Posts → Trash)
2. Delete the **"Sample Page"**
3. Delete the default **comments**
4. (Optional demo only) Mention Plugins screen: *"See these pre-installed plugins? We'll talk about plugins later — don't delete anything yet"*

Mini recap quiz (2 min, chat-based):

- *"Where do we change the URL structure?"* → Settings → Permalinks
- *"Home/About/Contact — posts or pages?"* → Pages
- *"Blog articles — posts or pages?"* → Posts

Block 5 — Q&A Buffer + Homework (5 min)

- Answer the "STUCK" students (usually login/password issues)
- Assign homework (see below)
- **Teaser for Class 4:** *"Next class we make your site beautiful — themes!"*

■ Homework Sheet (share with students)

Class 3 Homework — Due before Class 4 ■

#	Task	✓
1	Install WordPress on YOUR hosting (Hostinger Auto Installer)	■
2	Log in to `/wp-admin` with your credentials	■
3	Set your Site Title & Tagline (Settings → General)	■
4	Set Permalinks to "Post name"	■
5	Create a Page called **"About Me"** (write 3–4 lines about yourself)	■
6	Create a Post called **"Why I'm Learning WordPress"**	■
7	Delete the Hello World post and Sample Page	■

■ **Bonus challenge:** Create a second page called "Contact" (content can be simple text for now).

■ **Submission:** Post a screenshot of your live website's front page in the class group/chat.

■ Common Issues & Quick Fixes (for the teacher)

Problem	Fix
Student forgot admin password	hPanel → WordPress → overview → change password, OR "Lost your password?" link
Site shows "Not Secure"	hPanel → SSL → check status; SSL can take a few minutes after install

Student can't find wp-admin	Remind: it's `yourdomain.com/wp-admin` — check for typos
Install stuck/fails	Delete the install (hPanel → WordPress → Manage → Delete) and re-run Auto Installer
White screen / cached view	Ctrl+F5 or open in incognito

■ Full 2-Week Syllabus (context for where Class 3 fits)

Day	Class	Topic	Key Deliverable
1	Hosting Basics	Domains, hosting, DNS basics, Hostinger hPanel tour	—
2	WP Dashboard Intro	Tour of wp-admin, what each menu does	—
3	**Install & First Setup** ■■ *this one*	Auto Installer, settings, posts vs pages	Live site + 1 page + 1 post
4	Themes	Installing/activating themes, block vs classic themes, Site Editor basics	Theme chosen & activated
5	Block Editor Deep Dive	Gutenberg: blocks, patterns, columns, images	Nicely formatted post
6	Building a Home Page	Full page layout together: hero, sections, buttons	Finished Home page
7	Navigation & Branding	Menus, header/footer, logo, site identity, favicon	Complete site navigation
8	Plugins	What/why plugins, install essentials (security, SEO)	2–3 plugins installed
9	Forms & Media	Contact form plugin, image optimization, media library	Working contact form
10	Final Project	Each student builds a small site (e.g., a baby-products store like "BabyCocoon")	■ Finished website

Tip: Record every class and share the recording + this lesson plan's homework sheet in your class group. Beginners rewatch demos a LOT.